morning of Monday, 5 August 2019, in the Parliament by Union Home Minister Amit Shah. He announced that the government has decided to repeal both Article 370 and Article 35A of the Constitution which grants special status to the state. The government may have moved the Parliament to remove Article 370 but before doing so, it first rendered the provision toothless by revoking the 1954 Presidential proclamation through a gazette notification that very morning. With that revocation order, Article 35A, which granted special privileges about property ownership in Jammu & Kashmir to Kashmiri residents (or state subjects) now ceases to exist. reason being that this was inserted through a presidential proclamation of 1954, drawing powers from Article 370 itself. The Government of India has also decided to bifurcate the state into two Union territories—Jammu and Kashmir, which will have a legislature, and Ladakh, which will be without a legislature. The order passed on 5 August 2019, thus, made it possible for the government to introduce legislation to separate Ladakh from Jammu & Kashmir and make the remainder of the state a Union Territory with an assembly.

There are reasons to argue that as a collateral outcome, these changes have resulted in the people of Jammu and Ladakh to appear to have finally been freed from the tyranny of majoritarianism that the politicians in the Valley had subjected them to for the last 72 years. It can also be argued that for the common people of the Valley, the Maharaja’s feudal rule had been replaced by the feudal rule of a minuscule minority that had boxed them into a vicious circle of economic deprivation. This had been complemented over the past decade or more, by the steady implementation of an austere brand of Wahhabism. Both these shibboleths now seem suddenly shaky.

Once again, as it had done so for the first time in 1889, the Government of India has pre-empted international changes from wantonly impacting the fortunes of this state. In 1947, two parts of the entire state of Jammu & Kashmir that had acceded to India, namely Gilgit and it’s vassal states and the Muzaffarabad belt, were swallowed up by Pakistan. In the 1950s, China swallowed up a large part of Ladakh. So, the Government of India can hardly be blamed for this internal reorganisation as it prepares to meet the